DAY 25

When a Door Closes



"When their travel plans meet obstacles, Paul and his companions keep seeking guidance and later leave for Macedonia."

ACTS 16:6–10

The refusal arrived and seemed larger than the lost opportunity. You heard more than one possibility ending: perhaps you lacked ability, would never succeed, or had chosen wrongly. A closed door can invite conclusions about your whole life, especially when much hope rested there.

In Acts, Paul and his companions encounter obstacles during their mission. The account shows the Spirit's direction in that episode and their journey continuing toward another destination. Plans changed, but the mission did not end at its first limitation. A God-guided journey also included paths not traveled.

This passage cannot explain every refusal identically. Human choices, concrete limits, or injustice close some doors. You may need to challenge a decision, seek clarification, or grieve. Trusting God does not require calling every exclusion care or prevent responsible action.

Consider what the answer actually says. A rejected application does not define all your abilities. One lost possibility does not erase your resources. When disappointment mixes facts with sweeping judgments, separate them calmly. There may be something to learn or correct; the decision may also have little relation to your worth.

After the first shock, gather information. Are there other possibilities? Should you wait, prepare, or change direction? The next door is not always evident. Seek guidance without demanding immediate answers for everything. Prudence lets you assess whether an attempt deserves continuation or persistence merely increases strain.

A closed door may reveal how much hope rested on one result. Strong desire is understandable, but life contains more than this opportunity. Relationships, abilities, and purposes can find other expression. Loss remains real while the horizon gradually widens again.

You need not leave this reading certain something better will happen soon. Simply recognize that this refusal has not ended every possibility of walking onward. Bring disappointment to prayer and attend to the next visible step. Paul's story reminds us that seeking direction continues through obstacles without requiring the whole route known initially.



TO KEEP IN YOUR HEART

An ended possibility need not become a verdict on your whole life.



TODAY'S PRAYER

Lord, this closed door disappointed me and stirred doubts about myself and the future. Help me understand events without turning one answer into judgment of my worth. Give me wisdom to seek clarity, learn what is needed, and assess other paths. Receive grief for what I lost and widen my vision when I can continue. I want neither invented guarantees nor abandoned hope. Guide the next step and keep me open to possibilities I do not yet know. Amen.